The negative growth during 1911-21 was due to rapid and frequent occurrence of epidemics like cholera, plague and influenza and also famines. The year 1921 is known as the '***Year of Great Divide***' for India's population as population starts increasing.

During 1951, population growth rate has come down from 1.33% to 1.25%. Hence it is known as '***Year of Small divide***'.

In 1961, population of India started increasing at the rate of 1.96% i.e, 2%. Hence 1961 is known as '***Year of Population Explosion***'. In the year 2001, the Population of India crossed one billion (100 crore) mark.

The 2011 census reveals growth of youth population which is described as 'demographic transition'.

b. Birth rate and death rate

Crude Birth rate: It refers to the number of births per thousand of population.

Crude Death rate: It refers to the number of deaths per thousand of population.

Crude birth and death rates of India during various years.

Table 7.2
Birth rate and death rate

Year	C.B.R	C.D.R.
1951	39.9	27.4
2001	25.4	8.4
2011	21.8	7.11

(Source: Registrar General of India)

Birth rate was 39.9 in 1951; it fell to 21.8 in 2011. Although the birth rate has declined, the decline is not so remarkable. The death rate has declined from 27.4 in 1951 to 7.1 in 2011. However, from the data it is clear that the fall in birth rates is less than that of death rates.

Kerala has the lowest birth rate (14.7) and Uttar Pradesh has the highest birth rate (29.5). West Bengal has the lowest death rate (6.3) and Orissa (9.2) has the highest. Among States, Bihar has the highest decadal (2001-11) growth rate of population, while Kerala has the lowest growth rate. The four states Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh called ***BIMARU*** states have very high population.

c. Density of population

It refers to the average number of persons residing per square kilometre area or land. It represents the man- land ratio. As the total land area remains the same, an increase in population causes density of population to rise.

$$\text{Density of population} = \frac{\text{Total population}}{\text{Land area of the region}}$$

Table 7.3 Density of population

Year	Density of population (No. of persons per sq. km)
1951	117
2001	325
2011	382

(Source: Registrar General of India)

Just before Independence, the density of population was less than 100. But after independence, it has increased rapidly from 117 in 1951 to 325 in 2001. According to 2011 census, the present Density of population is 382. Thus, the pressure of population on land has been rising. Kerala,

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